

LANDING PAGE CONTENT

M.A. in India Studies

Understand India. Engage the World.

Postgraduate Degree | Duration: 1 Year | Batch Starts: September 2026 | Fully
Online Programme | Easy EMI Options

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Programme Highlights

- Pursue the only online Master's degree in India Studies offered by an Indian university.
- Gain broad interdisciplinary knowledge of India's rich history, politics, economy, religions, philosophies, art and business landscape.
- Study at JGU, a university ranked No. 1 in the world in the Times Higher Education Online Learning Rankings 2024.
- Learn 100% online through interactive classes that you can join from anywhere, with a schedule that adapts to your needs.
- Learn from leading scholars of India Studies drawn from diverse disciplines across O.P. Jindal Global University.
- Join a cohort of global learners from diverse professional and cultural backgrounds.

Who Should Apply?

- Diplomats, Politicians and Journalists
- Traders, Investors and Entrepreneurs
- Aspirants of Yoga, Meditation and Indian Spirituality
- Members of the Indian Diaspora
- Aspiring Scholars of India and South Asian Studies
- Indophiles and Cultural Enthusiasts

About the Programme:

The online Master of Arts in India Studies, offered by the Jindal India Institute (JII) at O.P. Jindal Global University (JGU), gives you a comprehensive understanding of India's complexity and global relevance. Over one year, you will explore India's politics, history, philosophy, economy, and cultural landscape—covering literature, cinema, music, and more—so you gain both depth and breadth of knowledge.

Designed for flexibility, the 100% online format allows you to learn from leading scholars while balancing work and personal commitments. Through an interdisciplinary approach and interactive learning experience, you will develop a well-rounded perspective on India's diversity and its evolving role in the global landscape—preparing you for careers across academia, policy, business, and beyond.

Faculty: our faculty bring together global scholarship and Indian insight — introducing the courses, questions, and inspirations that define the M.A. in India Studies.



Dr. Hindol Sengupta
Professor and Executive Dean, Jindal
School of International Affairs &
Director, Jindal India Institute



Dr. Swasti Rao
Associate Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs & Associate Dean,
Global Initiatives



Dr. Sugandha Nagpal
Associate Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs & Fellow, Jindal
India Institute



Dr. Archana Rath
Assistant Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs & Fellow, Jindal
India Institute



Dr. Sumeet Anand
Adjunct faculty, Jindal India Institute



Dr. Pooja Arora
Assistant Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs & Assistant Dean,
Extracurricular Activities



Ms. Bhavika Behal
Lecturer, Jindal School of International
Affairs & Programme Coordinator,
Online Programmes



Dr. Michal Erlich
Associate Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs & Director, Jindal
India Institute



Dr. Preethi Amaresh
Assistant Professor, Jindal School of
International Affairs



Mr. Raghav Dua
Lecturer, Jindal School of International
Affairs & Programmes Lead, Jindal India
Institute

Case Studies on Culture, Society, & Cinema

A curated set of case studies examining how heritage, migration, and films have shaped India's identity at home and across the world.

Cultural Heritage and Soft Power:

This case study looks at how the arts function as a core component of cultural strength and national prosperity. India's rich musical traditions give the country a unique opportunity to project its intangible heritage at home and abroad. The study considers how public-private collaboration, supported by technological innovation, can help India use culture as a source of soft power.

Ancient Traditions and Nation Building:

This case study looks at how India's old music and dance traditions help shape national identity. These traditions are not only forms of entertainment; they carry ideas and values that have been passed down for centuries. By protecting and promoting them, a nation can stay connected to its roots and draw guidance from its past.

From Past to Present: The Journey of the Indian Diaspora:

This case study traces the journey of Indians who moved to different parts of the world. It covers early traders, indentured workers during colonial rule, and today's professionals. The study shows how the diaspora influences the culture, economy, and politics of both India and their new countries.

Deewar:

This case study explores the thrilling Salim-Javed blockbuster hit from the 1970s. It connects the rise of the "Angry Young Man" archetype to the turbulent socio-political context of India during the Emergency period. The narrative allows us to empathize more deeply with the rise and fall of grey protagonists in Bollywood cinema.

Eligibility

- Applicants to this programme must hold a bachelor's degree in any discipline from a recognised university.
- Passport for International Applicants & Govt. Issued ID Proof (Aadhar Card/PAN Card/Voter ID) for Indian Applicants.

Application Process

- **Statement of Purpose (500-700 words)**
- **Short Essay (800-1000 words) on one of the following:**
 - What aspect of India's history, culture, or philosophy inspires you the most, and why?
 - Which one aspect of India, according to you, has the potential to make a positive impact in shaping the 21st century?
- Document Review
- Applications accepted on a rolling basis

Fees and Finance

Tuition Fee

- ₹2,50,000 (for Indian applicants). For international learners, tuition is payable in equivalent local currency at the time of payment.
- Indian students have the option to pay their tuition fees in multiple installments, as outlined below:

Fee Component	Amount (INR)	Due Date
Block Amount	50,000	Upon acceptance of the offer letter
Installment-I	1,00,000	20 Days after the Programme begins
Installment-II	1,00,000	Prior to the commencement of Term 3

Flexible Payment Options

Pay conveniently through JODOCRED, with low-interest monthly instalments and a fully digital 15-minute approval process.

Key Benefits

- A fully digital journey that can be completed within 15 minutes from application to loan agreement.
- Only your PAN number is required for initial registration and approval.
- 24×7 helpline available to guide you through the application process. · Begin your application at app.jodo.in/jgu

For assistance, connect directly with JODO representatives at 99729 82193 or 96201 42953.

From the Student Community

Vinay Chawla (Founder, Asian Centre for Development Engineering)

"I joined the first batch of the M.A. in India Studies at O.P. Jindal Global University after exploring many options in India that could support my social start-up in development engineering. This online programme fits perfectly and brings more than just theory.

In the first trimester, we explored Indian history, politics, and philosophies like Hinduism, Buddhism, and Jainism through real conversations with great professors. They make complex ideas clear and easy to relate to for anyone. My classmates are from all over the world and share many perspectives.

The programme is helping me find the right business case and the exact social issue I want to focus on for my start-up. If you want to connect academic study with real impact, especially for future social entrepreneurs, this programme stands out."

Koji Sato (Director General, The Japan Foundation, New Delhi Office)

"I have been associated with India for a long time, and I am currently living and working in Delhi. With more than eight years of experience here, I felt I knew India well...but I wanted to deepen my understanding of this wonderful country and its culture. When I discovered the M.A. in India Studies programme online, I knew it was the right course for me.

So far, I have taken three courses, and one of them also focused on philosophy and religion. All have been excellent, but the philosophy and religion course, in particular, made me feel like I was reaching the very core of the Indian heart.

The programme's online format is a huge advantage. The video lectures are well-designed, and I can study at my own pace, something very valuable for professionals like me. Some assessments were challenging, but that was also the fun part. Returning to academics after 20-30 years, writing a short thesis was truly exciting and has motivated me to keep learning and developing. Whether you are a student, job seeker, or professional anywhere in the world, this programme offers a concentrated, one-year journey that immerses you deeply in India's history, culture, and much more. I strongly recommend it to anyone interested."

Rajni P. (Student, O.P. Jindal Global University)

"The M.A. in India Studies programme at the O.P. Jindal Global University has been such a unique and eye-opening experience for me. I joined the programme wanting to learn more about India's history, culture, philosophy, politics, and international relations.

The faculty are greatly knowledgeable, and their ability to make complex subjects accessible has made the classes both engaging and inspiring. I also greatly value the supportive environment created by the staff. The vibrant exchange of perspectives within the cohort, by interacting with classmates from across the globe, has broadened my own outlook about India and made the journey even more rewarding.

This programme has strengthened my understanding of India's past, present, and future, and I would highly recommend it to anyone with a genuine curiosity about India."

Muiris Ó Céidigh

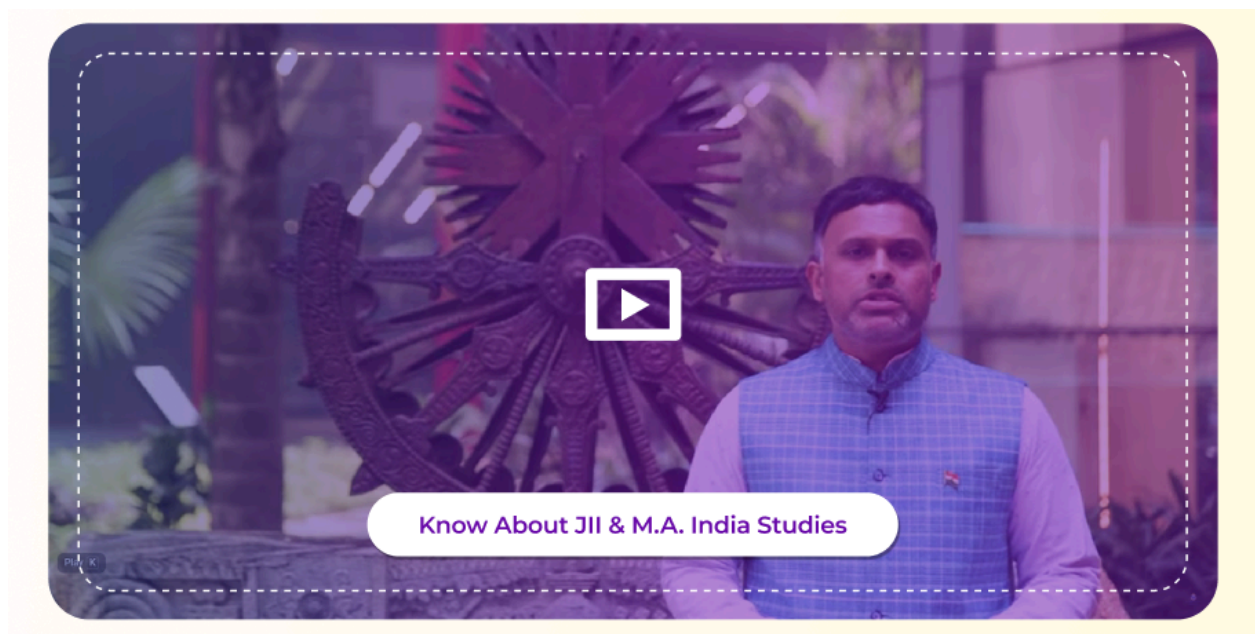
"I recently started the M.A. in India Studies at O.P. Jindal Global University, and it is absolutely mind-blowing! You're introduced to ancient literature, history, and so much more. If you think Greece had it all, India is far more ancient and just as developed as the Roman civilisation, cities, public works, and administration.

Sanskrit, the great ancient Indo-Aryan language of India and the liturgical language of Hinduism, Buddhism, and Jainism, is a key source for many modern languages, with deep links to both Latin and Greek. Yet all this has been largely ignored in Western histories...And

today? India is racing ahead! This is a brilliant programme where you learn about India in all its colour and complexity, taught by Indian professors who brim with enthusiasm for a country that is already a world power."

Michael Barnaby Levin (Yoga Instructor, Former Senior Research Associate)

"I just completed the first term of the M.A. India Studies programme, and the experience has been nothing short of amazing. As an American who has utterly fallen in love with India, first through yoga and then through travel, I was looking for a way to broaden my knowledge of the country's history, politics, economics, and culture, and the curriculum in this programme is precisely what I was after. It's well-rounded, engaging, and I've found it all quite fascinating. It's taught by faculty who are enthusiastic about their subjects and about sharing their love of them in this programme, and they're supported by staff who are genuinely helpful. I've really enjoyed meeting the cohort of students from all over the world. I already feel that I have learned a great deal and will look at India in a different light on my next visit. By the time I finish the programme, I know that the depth of my knowledge and understanding of India -where it has been and where it's going-will be truly remarkable, though never complete."



The Jindal India Institute

The Jindal India Institute (JII) is the flagship think-tank initiative of the O.P. Jindal Global University (JGU), aimed at promoting a comprehensive and contextual understanding of India around the world. India's rising influence in the world has created an unprecedented demand for a richer, more textured, and interdisciplinary understanding of its complexities – historical, cultural, political, economic, and philosophical.

JII responds to this demand through a wide range of initiatives, including training programmes for foreign diplomats, research projects, expert-led public events, and a pioneering Master of Arts (M.A.) in India Studies, the first of its kind in the online domain, and the only such programme in India.

Recognitions and Accreditations



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Is it possible to work while enrolled in the programme?



What career opportunities does this programme prepare me for?



What is unique about this programme



Is there an entrance test?



What learning resources are available?



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Current State* ▾

Current City* ▾

Select Course*



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